

Features of different versions of Android Jelly Bean

ANDROID 4.1

Project Butter. With Project Butter, Google has allowed the CPU and graphics in the device run in parallel, rather than crash into each other. Project Butter allows the entire interface to run at 60 frames per second (FPS) speed on a sufficiently fast hardware clearing issues related to device lag.

Offline voice typing. Android 4.1 addressed the issue of dictating something to your phone even if the users do not have a cellular or Wi-Fi data connection.

Google Now. With Google Now, Android gets intuitive and tries to predict what you will need and manage it for you even before your realising that you need it.

Voice search. More like Apple's Siri, the S-Voice search added in Android 4.1 enables Google to get the best answers for your query first, followed by relevant search results.

Notifications. The notifications bar in Android 4.1 can do better than ever. You can expand it to show you a portion of your inbox rather than just the number of unread emails.

ANDROID 4.2

Better photo editing features. For those who forget how original picture looked whilst editing a photograph, Android 4.2 is there to help with its improvised photo-editing features. It requires only a simple gesture to get back to the original photo without even missing on any of the edits you have made.

Jelly Bean Daydreams screensaver mode. This version of Jelly Bean OS comes with an all-new screensaver mode. This screensaver gets activated when your device is docked or is in the

charging mode. Google likes to term these as Daydreams, and not screensavers.

Photo Sphere. This new feature of Android 4.2 allows the users to take a 360-degree panoramic photograph of surroundings. Once the photograph is clicked, you can see the Photo Sphere created and use the gyroscope of your device to view it. You can also upload the Photo Sphere on Google Maps.

ANDROID 4.3

Restricted profiles for users. You can use this feature to ensure that your children do not access anything that you do not want them to see. This feature helps you decide the apps the user of the profile can access and if he can use Google Play Store for adding new apps.

Office suite for managing documents. You can access and edit documents whilst travelling by using certain great free office suites. Amongst them is Kingsoft Office that allows you to open no less than 23 types of document files, which include DOC, DOCX, XLS, XLSX, PPT, PPTX or PDF. You can download it from the Google Play store.

Not limiting yourself to apps from the Google Play Store. Contrary to iOS, Android permits you to install apps from non-Play Store sources. This helps you in getting better deals on apps that are on offer in other stores.

Stay organised with Google Keep. Google Keep was launched in the early part of last year. It is a user-friendly tool that helps you in keeping yourself organised. It can be used for taking notes like voice recordings, images or text.

or not is equally important before you actually invest in a smartphone. Most of the Android Jelly Bean smartphones come with 8GB, 16GB and 32GB variants. You have to decide the storage space depending on your need. For a low-end device, ensure that the option of expanding the storage is present.

Battery. One of the persistent issues that Android smartphones face is loss of battery power. This issue has not improved in Android phones for years. Although, let us not forget that our dealing with smartphones has also changed over a period of time, which also affects

the battery life. Most of the Android smartphones carry the batteries having capacities to the tune of 2000mAh or more. Before you invest in an Android smartphone, do understand your usage needs. Also, the larger the screen size, the more battery it consumes.

Android upgrade. Before you buy an Android smartphone, you must check out whether the device is good for future upgrades or not. Usually global brands are more prompt in providing firmware upgrades, whilst the home-grown brands take their time to provide upgrades. So do make an

informed choice before you invest.

Camera. OEMs provide somewhere between 5MP and 13MP rear cameras. Unfortunately, some of them avoid flash feature, which is important for good-quality pictures. An 8MP camera without flash makes lesser sense than a 5MP camera with flash. HD recording is of course a must-have feature for modern-day smartphone users.

Besides the rear camera, a good front camera is something really important for those who like to connect on Skype or video chat. ●

The author is senior assistant editor at EFY



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